

Plant Systems Career Evidence Guide



NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Three ways people improve plant and food systems

All pay figures are **May 2024 U.S. median annual wages**. They are not starting pay and not DFW-local wages. Outlook figures are national projections for **2024-2034**.

CAREER	WHAT THE WORKER DOES	TYPICAL ENTRY ROUTE	2024 U.S. MEDIAN	2024-34 OUTLOOK
Agricultural and Food Science Technician	Helps scientists test plants, soil, food, and production methods; records samples and data	Usually an associate degree; entry routes vary and may include related experience	\$48,480	5% growth
Soil and Plant Scientist	Studies soil, crops, pests, water, and growing methods to improve plant production and protect resources	At least a bachelor's degree in plant biology, agriculture, or a related field	\$71,410	5% growth
Agricultural Engineer	Designs and tests equipment, structures, environmental controls, irrigation, and automated farm systems	Bachelor's degree in agricultural, biological, or another engineering field	\$84,630	6% growth

READ THE MEASURES CORRECTLY

- **Median** means half of workers earn more and half earn less. It does not predict a new worker's first salary.
- **Outlook** is a national projection, not a promise that every local employer will hire.
- A specialty such as hydroponics, precision agriculture, or controlled-environment growing may sit inside a broader occupation. Job titles vary.
- More education can expand responsibility and pay, but it also requires more time, cost, and preparation.

FIRST LOOK

Role with the shortest typical route: _____ Highest median: _____

One role that combines agriculture and technology: _____

Current Irving ISD connection

Irving ISD's current public CTE page lists **Plant Science at Nimitz High School** in the School of Agriculture Science. The same page lists the student-run **Nimitz Floral Studio Flower Shop**. These are current program facts checked August 8, 2026.

The *Find Your Future* workbook gives additional curriculum context about the district program. Treat any specific course, certification, facility, or outcome printed in the workbook as context until a current district source confirms it.

Important boundary: A high-school pathway can build knowledge, experience, and connections. It does not guarantee a certification, job, salary, admission, or college credit.

SOURCES CHECKED AUGUST 8, 2026

- U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Agricultural and Food Science Technicians; Agricultural and Food Scientists; Agricultural Engineers. Pay: May 2024. Outlook: 2024-2034.
- Irving ISD, Nimitz High School Career and Technical Education page.

Use the evidence

Which role would be most involved in testing a failing hydroponic system? Use one duty and one education fact.

What is one trade-off between the route with the shortest preparation and the route with the highest median pay?

What is one fact you would still need before choosing a route for yourself?